



Black Ops II breaks record

Activision claims it's the fastest selling pre-order game ever with the official trailer being viewed more than 9 million times <http://dgit.in/Kzqw8Q>

'Touché' and go

A smartphone silencing itself or a chair adjusting room lighting to user's preference, Touché, can do it all <http://dgit.in/IspyKK>



Your Google Docs files will show up in Drive when you sign up for it

points. Not to be left behind, Microsoft is attempting to counter that with more storage on offer from the outset – 7 GB. If you happen to be an existing user, we suggest you immediately claim the free 25GB retention upgrade while it still lasts. Meanwhile, Dropbox will really have to seriously rework the free storage options because 2 GB (before any referral upgrades) is just too less.

Office goes online

With Google Drive, you can continue to create, edit, store and share your documents from within one service. This negates the need to have a dedicated office suite installed on your PC or smartphone. It will undoubtedly appeal to those who already use Google Docs as a productivity tool. Those looking for a dead simple way to collaborate with others on documents, spreadsheets and presentations, now have another reason to use Google's cloud offering. Google Drive already has an app for Android devices, with the iOS version in the works.

Microsoft's SkyDrive offering works on similar lines as Google Docs, with its entire Office suite available on the cloud as Office Web Apps. The feature set is comparable to Google Drive, but Google's sharing and collaborative features are far superior. The web version of Microsoft Office is a watered down replica of its desktop suite, with many handy features missing. A feature bump is much desired.

Dropbox allows you to share files and folders almost effortlessly, but doesn't have an built-in Office suite like it's competitors. You'll have to rely on a third-party tool like Google Docs or OpenOffice on the PC to view/edit your files, while Dropbox will take care of the syncing and sharing. There is a silver lining though – Dropbox can handle a wider variety of files, since it's file-format agnostic.

Smartphone & Tablet apps

The Google Drive app for Android replicates the entire feature set of Google Drive on the web for a smartphone or tablet. Just like Dropbox, it syncs all files, irrespective of which device it was created on. And the desktop app for Mac and PC will keep your Google Drive folder completely up to date. Files can be marked as 'favourite' to make them available offline on your Android device.

Dropbox clearly has the advantage of a tried and tested app – available on most smartphone platforms – Android,

iOS and BlackBerry.

The desktop app works without a hitch - it creates a folder on your desktop, and anything you place in that folder will be synced to the cloud. It's not surprising that Microsoft has SkyDrive apps for its own Windows Phone platform, but they it also has one for iOS devices, which do everything the web



Availability on multiple platforms and devices makes it "seamless"

version does – edit documents, browse and view pictures and even sync files on your mobile device to the cloud. The recently released desktop app gives it a huge advantage, offering Dropbox-like file syncing – albeit only on Windows machines. For smartphone users, Dropbox probably makes most sense. Paired with the app on your PC/ laptop, any changes made to your Dropbox folder on the desktop will be reflected in the mobile app, and vice versa. One handy feature of Dropbox is Camera Upload, where any photos taken with the smartphone camera will be automatically uploaded to Dropbox. Users can turn off the feature if they choose, but it's a handy way to backup your photos. Plus, you get 512MB of free storage for the first photo you upload and an additional 512MB for the next 512MB of photos you upload, upto a total of 3GB.



Dropbox is very popular, considering the simplicity of use and ability to boost free storage

The winner: Dropbox

Without a shadow of a doubt, both Microsoft and Google have taken inspiration from what Dropbox has been doing perfectly for years. And it isn't surprising that Dropbox is the sensible choice here – seamless sync, impressive presence on almost all platforms and wide format handling. While it gives you only 2GB to start with, getting extra space is a breeze, upto a total of almost 22GB! It doesn't offer document editing capabilities, but for someone looking for a dead simple file-syncing service, Dropbox is the way to go. **d**